

April

29

1429

Maid of Orléans

During the Hundred Years' War between France and England, 17-year-old Joan of Arc led the French army to free the city of Orléans, which had been besieged by the English. She became a legendary figure and was made a patron saint of France in 1920.



Also on this day

1770 Explorer James Cook and his crew landed at Botany Bay in Australia, beginning British interest in colonizing the continent.

1961 The World Wildlife Fund (WWF) was set up to raise money to protect animals and habitats that are threatened by humans.

2011 Millions of TV viewers watched as Prince William, Duke of Cambridge, married Catherine Middleton in a lavish ceremony at London's Westminster Abbey.

Most wanted

Nancy Wake, one of Britain's leading special agents in World War II, parachuted into France. There, she assembled a resistance group to attack German forces. She eventually reached the top of the Nazis' most-wanted list.

1944



Born this day

1863 William Randolph Hearst, Sr, US newspaper publisher and entrepreneur. He was the founder of Hearst Corporation, one of the USA's largest media companies.

1899 Edward Kennedy "Duke" Ellington, Black American musician. Often called America's greatest jazz composer, he wrote more than 2,000 songs.